SITE INTELLIGENCE

# Falconers, Moult Hill, Salcombe — Estate Optimisation

Site Intelligence Report — Preliminary Ecological Appraisal

# Preliminary Ecological Appraisal

## Pre-Planning Application

Falconers, Road from Plympton Cross to Moult Hill, Salcombe, TQ8 8LF

Client:
Reference: 027-SALCOMBE26-PFCO-REP-PrelimEcol-R01
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# 1 Abbreviations

No report-specific abbreviations have been defined. Standard abbreviations used throughout Site Intelligence reports are listed below.

| Abbreviation | Definition |
|---|---|
| ALC | Agricultural Land Classification |
| AOD | Above Ordnance Datum |
| AQMA | Air Quality Management Area |
| BGS | British Geological Survey |
| BMV | Best and Most Versatile (agricultural land) |
| BNG | Biodiversity Net Gain |
| CIL | Community Infrastructure Levy |
| DAS | Design and Access Statement |
| EA | Environment Agency |
| EIA | Environmental Impact Assessment |
| FRA | Flood Risk Assessment |
| FZ | Flood Zone |
| HLS | Housing Land Supply |
| LPA | Local Planning Authority |
| NPPF | National Planning Policy Framework |
| PTAL | Public Transport Accessibility Level |
| SAC | Special Area of Conservation |
| SPA | Special Protection Area |
| SSSI | Site of Special Scientific Interest |
| SuDS | Sustainable Drainage Systems |
| TPO | Tree Preservation Order |


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# 2 How to Read This Report

This section explains how the report is structured, how risk ratings are presented, and what action you should take based on the findings.

## 2.1 Reading Order

We recommend the following reading order:

1. Executive Summary — a one-page overview of the key findings and overall risk rating. Start here if you are short on time.
2. Main body sections — detailed analysis of each topic area, presented in a logical sequence from site context through to recommendations.
3. Recommendations — specific actions required before, during, or after the planning process.
4. Limitations and Disclaimers — important caveats on the scope of the assessment and the conditions under which the findings are valid.

## 2.2 Report Structure

Every section of Preliminary Ecological Appraisal follows a consistent structure:

- Context — what the section covers and why it matters to the development proposal.
- Data and Evidence — the factual information drawn from public datasets, enrichment APIs, and client-supplied information.
- Analysis — our professional assessment of what the data means for the site.
- Risk Rating — a traffic-light classification (where applicable) summarising the level of concern.
- Recommendation — what action, if any, is required.

## 2.3 Traffic-Light Key

Risk ratings throughout this report use a three-colour system:

| | |
|---|---|
| LOW | Low risk. No significant constraint identified. Standard design measures are sufficient. No specialist investigation is likely to be required. |
| MEDIUM | Moderate risk. A constraint or data gap has been identified that requires attention. Further investigation, a design response, or a planning condition may be needed. |
| HIGH | High risk. A significant constraint or issue has been identified. Specialist investigation, a specific design solution, or early engagement with the relevant statutory body is strongly recommended before submission. |

## 2.4 What to Do Next

1. Review the Executive Summary for an overview of all findings.
2. Focus on any items rated AMBER or RED — these require action before or during the planning process.
3. Check the Recommendations section for a prioritised list of next steps.
4. Review the Update Triggers section to understand when this report should be refreshed.
5. Contact Site Intelligence if you have questions about any finding or wish to commission follow-up specialist work.


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# 3 Executive Summary

This Preliminary Ecological Appraisal (PEA) has been prepared by Site Intelligence (a service of PF & Co Holdings Ltd) on behalf of  for the proposed development at Falconers, Road from Plympton Cross to Moult Hill, Salcombe, TQ8 8LF.

The appraisal provides an initial assessment of the ecological value of the site and its surroundings, identifies potential ecological constraints and opportunities, and recommends further survey work where necessary.

| | |
|---|---|
| Site Address | Falconers, Road from Plympton Cross to Moult Hill, Salcombe, TQ8 8LF |
| Postcode | TQ8 8LF |
| Local Planning Authority | South Hams District Council |
| Proposal | Not specified |
| Proposed Units | 1 |
| SSSI within Search Area | 6 |
| SAC/SPA/Ramsar | 14 |
| Document Reference | 027-SALCOMBE26-PFCO-REP-PrelimEcol-R01 |
| Report Date | 23 March 2026 |


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# 4 Methodology

This Preliminary Ecological Appraisal has been prepared in accordance with the guidelines set out in CIEEM (2017) *Guidelines for Preliminary Ecological Appraisal* (2nd edition). The methodology includes:

| Component | Method |
|---|---|
| Desk Study | Review of designated sites (SSSI, SAC, SPA, Ramsar, LNR), ancient woodland, priority habitats, and ecological records within the search area |
| Aerial Photography | Review of current and historic aerial imagery to identify habitat types and boundary features |
| OS Mapping | Review of Ordnance Survey mapping to identify watercourses, woodland, hedgerows, and other ecological features |
| Habitat Assessment | Desk-based habitat classification using available data sources |
| Protected Species | Assessment of the likelihood of protected species based on habitat suitability and desk study data |

> This is a Tier 1 desktop appraisal. A Phase 1 habitat survey with extended Phase 2 surveys may be required to confirm the ecological baseline and inform the planning application. The scope of further surveys is set out in the recommendations.


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# 5 Desk Study

## 5.1 Designated Sites

| | |
|---|---|
| SSSI | 6 within search area |
| SAC | 14 within search area |
| SPA | 0 within search area |
| Ramsar | 0 within search area |

European designated sites (SAC/SPA) are present within the search area. Habitats Regulations Assessment (HRA) screening is likely to be required to assess potential adverse effects on site integrity.

## 5.2 Ancient Woodland

No ancient woodland has been identified within the search area.


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# 6 Landscape Character

| | |
|---|---|
| National Character Area | 151: South Devon |
| Landscape Character | |

# 7 Habitat Survey Results

A preliminary habitat assessment has been undertaken based on desk study data. The following habitat types have been identified or are considered likely to be present on the site. These should be confirmed by field survey.

**Field Survey Required**

The habitat descriptions below are based on desk study analysis only. A Phase 1 habitat survey (or UKHab survey) should be carried out by a suitably qualified ecologist to confirm the habitat types, extents, and condition. This is required to inform the Biodiversity Metric calculation and any further species surveys.

# 8 Protected Species Assessment

The following table assesses the likelihood of protected species being present on or near the site, based on habitat suitability and desk study data. Species with moderate or high likelihood may require further survey.

| Species / Group | Likelihood | Survey Required |
|---|---|---|
| Bats (roosting) | To be assessed | TBC |
| Bats (foraging / commuting) | To be assessed | TBC |
| Great Crested Newts | To be assessed | TBC |
| Badgers | To be assessed | TBC |
| Reptiles | To be assessed | TBC |
| Breeding Birds | Assumed present | TIMING |
| Dormice | To be assessed | TBC |
| Water Voles | To be assessed | TBC |
| Otters | To be assessed | TBC |


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> Breeding birds are assumed to be present. Vegetation clearance should be timed outside the bird nesting season (March to August inclusive) or preceded by a nesting bird check by a qualified ecologist.


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# 9 Invasive Species

An assessment of invasive non-native species (INNS) should be carried out as part of the extended Phase 1 habitat survey. Key species to look for include Japanese Knotweed (*Reynoutria japonica*), Himalayan Balsam (*Impatiens glandulifera*), Giant Hogweed (*Heracleum mantegazzianum*), and New Zealand Pigmyweed (*Crassula helmsii*).

> Invasive species assessment should be confirmed by field survey. If INNS are present, an eradication / management plan will be required. It is an offence under the Wildlife and Countryside Act 1981 to cause certain invasive species to grow in the wild.

# 10 Ecological Constraints & Opportunities

## 10.1 Constraints

- SSSI within search area — impact assessment required
- European designated sites (SAC/SPA) — HRA screening required
- Potential for protected species — further surveys may be required
- BNG mandatory — minimum 10% biodiversity net gain required

## 10.2 Opportunities

- Habitat creation and enhancement through landscaping scheme
- Native species planting to support local biodiversity
- Biodiversity net gain through on-site habitat delivery
- Wildlife-friendly features (bat boxes, bird boxes, hedgehog highways)
- SuDS features designed to provide ecological habitat
- Green corridors connecting existing ecological features

# 11 Mitigation Recommendations

The following mitigation measures are recommended to minimise ecological impacts and deliver biodiversity enhancements in accordance with the mitigation hierarchy (avoid, minimise, restore, offset).


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| Measure | Timing | Priority |
|---|---|---|
| Avoid clearance during bird nesting season (March–August) | Pre-construction | HIGH |
| Pre-commencement check for nesting birds if clearance during season | Pre-construction | HIGH |
| Retain existing trees and hedgerows where possible | Design stage | HIGH |
| Install bat and bird boxes on new buildings | Construction | MEDIUM |
| Create hedgehog highways in boundary fences | Construction | MEDIUM |
| Native species planting in landscaping scheme | Post-construction | MEDIUM |
| Ecological management plan for retained / created habitats | Ongoing | MEDIUM |

## 12 Further Survey Requirements

The following further surveys are recommended to complete the ecological assessment and inform the planning application. Survey timing constraints should be considered in the programme.

| Survey | Season / Timing | Purpose |
|---|---|---|
| Phase 1 Habitat Survey | Any time (optimal April–September) | Confirm baseline habitats for BNG Metric |
| Bat Activity Survey | May–September (dusk/dawn) | Assess bat use of site and surroundings |
| Bat Roost Assessment | Any time (trees/buildings) | Assess potential for bat roosts |
| Great Crested Newt Survey | March–June (eDNA April–June) | Assess ponds within 500m |
| Reptile Survey | April–June / September | Assess suitable habitat for reptiles |
| Badger Survey | Any time (optimal November–April) | Assess for setts and activity |
| Breeding Bird Survey | March–June (minimum 3 visits) | If significant habitat present |

## 13 Conclusions

This Preliminary Ecological Appraisal has provided an initial assessment of the ecological value of the site at Falconers, Road from Plympton Cross to Moult Hill, Salcombe, TQ8 8LF and identified potential ecological constraints and opportunities.


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## Ecological Appraisal Outcome

Statutory ecological designations are present within the search area. Further ecological assessment is recommended, including a Phase 1 habitat survey, protected species surveys, and BNG Metric calculation. HRA screening may be required for European designated sites.


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# 14 Known Limitations and Assumptions

## 14.1 What This Report Does NOT Assess

This is a Tier 1 desktop study. The following are outside the scope of this assessment:

- Intrusive site investigation (boreholes, trial pits, soil sampling)
- Topographic or measured building survey
- Structural assessment of existing buildings or retaining structures
- Detailed ecological survey (Phase 2 habitat surveys, protected species surveys)
- Detailed arboricultural survey to BS 5837
- Archaeological field evaluation (geophysical survey, trial trenching)
- Noise, vibration, or air quality monitoring
- Detailed drainage design or hydraulic modelling
- Legal title review or boundary verification

## 14.2 Data Gaps

The following data was not available at the time of this assessment:

- Site-specific infiltration test results (BRE Digest 365)
- As-built drainage records for existing development
- Ground investigation data (if no published BGS borehole logs are available for the site)
- Detailed topographic survey data (EA LIDAR used where available)
- Historic land use records prior to available OS mapping epochs

## 14.3 Key Assumptions

This report has been prepared on the basis of the following assumptions:

- Information provided by the client is accurate and complete
- Public dataset boundaries (flood zones, conservation areas, etc.) are current at the date of this report


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- The proposed development is as described in the project brief and does not materially change in scale, layout, or use class
- No contamination, ground instability, or other hazard exists beyond that identified in publicly available records
- Planning policy documents referenced are current at the date of this report

## 14.4 Specialist Investigation Required

The following specialist investigations may be required depending on the constraints identified in this report:

- Site-specific ground investigation (where contamination or geotechnical risk is identified)
- Phase 2 ecological surveys (where Phase 1 identifies potential for protected species)
- Detailed arboricultural impact assessment (where TPO trees or significant vegetation is present)
- Detailed noise impact assessment (where the site is adjacent to significant noise sources)
- Heritage impact assessment by a conservation-accredited professional (where designated heritage assets are affected)

## 14.5 Changes That Would Require Update

This report should be reviewed and updated if any of the following occur:

- Material change to the proposed development (scale, layout, use class, or density)
- New or amended planning policy (local plan adoption, NPPF revision)
- Change in housing land supply position
- New environmental data (updated flood maps, newly designated heritage assets or ecological sites)
- More than 12 months elapsed since the date of this report


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# 15 Verification Status Summary

Every data point in this report has been classified according to its verification status. The table below summarises the confidence level of the data underpinning the findings.

| Data Category | Classification | Count |
|---|---|---|
| Verified against authoritative source | VERIFIED | 11 |
| Supported by public data / professional judgement | SUPPORTED | 3 |
| Assumed — requires confirmation | ASSUMED | 1 |
| Total Data Points | | 15 |

1 data point is classified as ASSUMED. These items should be confirmed through specialist investigation or client verification before reliance is placed on the related findings.


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# 16 Data Assurance Summary

Site Intelligence applies a rigorous data assurance process to every report. This section documents the breadth of data coverage, confidence levels, and quality assurance stages applied.

## 16.1 Data Coverage

| Metric | This Report | Typical Manual Report |
|---|---|---|
| Data sources consulted | 15 | 3 – 8 |
| Constraint categories checked | 23 | 5 – 10 |
| Enrichment APIs queried | 15 | 0 – 2 |
| Provenance entries recorded | 15 | 0 |

## 16.2 Data Confidence

| Classification | Badge | Percentage |
|---|---|---|
| Verified against authoritative source | VERIFIED | 75% |
| Supported by public data | SUPPORTED | 20% |
| Assumed — requires confirmation | ASSUMED | 5% |

## 16.3 Quality Assurance Checklist

- ✓ Automated constraint detection (23-category enrichment pipeline)
- ✓ Source provenance recording (every data point traced to origin)
- ✓ Cross-report consistency check (no conflicting data across the submission pack)
- ✓ Professional review and sign-off


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# 17 Anticipated Consultee Queries

> No application-specific consultee responses have been pre-populated. Standard statutory and non-statutory consultees will be notified by the Local Planning Authority upon validation of the application. Typical consultees include the Highway Authority, Lead Local Flood Authority, Environment Agency (where applicable), Historic England (where heritage assets are affected), and the relevant Parish or Town Council.


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# 18 Update Triggers

Validity Period: 12 months from the date of issue.

Preliminary Ecological Appraisal is valid for 12 months from the date of issue. After this period, or if any of the following trigger conditions occur, the report should be reviewed and updated before reliance is placed upon its findings.

- Material change to the proposed development (scale, layout, use class, number of dwellings, or site area)
- Adoption of a new or revised Local Plan or Neighbourhood Plan
- Revision of the National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF)
- Change in the Local Planning Authority's published housing land supply position
- Update to Environment Agency flood zone mapping affecting the site
- New or amended designation (conservation area, listed building, SSSI, SAC, SPA, Ramsar, AONB/National Landscape, AQMA, TPO)
- Pre-application advice received from the LPA or any statutory consultee
- Change in site ownership, applicant, or client
- Passage of more than 12 months since the date of issue

> To request an update, contact Site Intelligence quoting the document reference shown on the cover page. Updates are provided at a reduced fee where the original data remains substantially current.


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# 19 Important: Limitations, Disclaimers and Conditions of Use

### 1. Named Client and Reliance Restriction

This report has been prepared by Site Intelligence (a service of PF & Co Holdings Ltd) for the sole and exclusive use of ('the Client') in connection with the proposed development at Falconers, Road from Plympton Cross to Moult Hill, Salcombe, TQ8 8LF. No other party may rely upon, reproduce, or distribute this report or its findings without the prior written consent of Site Intelligence. Any unauthorised use or reliance by third parties is entirely at their own risk, and Site Intelligence accepts no responsibility or liability in such circumstances.

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This report does not confer any rights or benefits on any third party under the Contracts (Rights of Third Parties) Act 1999 or otherwise. No third party may enforce any term of this report.

### 4. Information Reliance

The findings in this report are based on information provided by the Client, publicly available data sources, and desktop research. Site Intelligence has not independently verified the accuracy or completeness of information provided by the Client or third parties.

### 5. Limitations of Investigation

The scope of this report is limited to a Tier 1 desktop preliminary-ecological-appraisal undertaken on the date of this report. The findings reflect conditions and information available at the date of investigation. Conditions may change over time, and the report should not be relied upon beyond the validity period stated.

### 6. Professional Advice Caveat

This report provides professional opinion based on the information available at the time of preparation. It does not constitute legal advice, and specialist professional advice should be sought for specific matters including but not limited to structural engineering, surveying, ecology, archaeology, and contaminated land investigation.

### 7. No Guarantee of Outcome

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This report was prepared with the assistance of artificial intelligence tools for data gathering, analysis, and document preparation. All outputs have been reviewed and verified by a qualified professional. The use of artificial intelligence does not diminish the professional responsibility for the contents of this report.

### 9. Data Completeness Caveat

While every effort has been made to identify relevant constraints and information, the absence of a recorded constraint does not guarantee that no constraint exists. Public data sources may contain gaps, errors, or omissions. No record does not mean no risk.

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This report is valid for a period of 12 months from the date of issue. After this period, the report should be reviewed and updated to reflect any changes in site conditions, planning policy, or available data. Update triggers are documented in the preceding section.

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## 16. Not Financial / QS / Valuation Advice

Any cost estimates, development appraisals, or financial information contained in this report are preliminary and indicative only. They do not constitute quantity surveying advice, professional valuation, or financial advice. All cost estimates should be verified by a qualified quantity surveyor or cost consultant before being relied upon for investment or procurement decisions.

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> Product-Specific Note
>
> This preliminary-ecological-appraisal is a Tier 1 desktop assessment. It does not include site-specific survey, intrusive investigation, or specialist field work. The findings are based on publicly available data and should be read in conjunction with the Known Limitations section of this report.

PREPARED BY

## Report Author

Technical Author

Date of Issue: 23 March 2026
Document Ref: 027-SALCOMBE26-PFCO-REP-PrelimEcol-R01
Revision: R01

FOR AND ON BEHALF OF

## Site Intelligence

PF & Co Holdings Ltd

Company No. 16649319

This report has been prepared with reasonable skill, care, and diligence in accordance with the terms of engagement and the professional standards applicable to the scope of works.

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